

L E S S O N 23

Faithful Stewardship: God Owns Everything

10: Stewardship and Service

Scripture Focus: 1 Corinthians 4:2 · Psalm 24:1

This lesson begins the stewardship and service section by considering God's ownership and the believer's responsibility to be faithful.

BY THE END

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to 1 Corinthians 4:2 and Psalm 24:1.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

VOCABULARY

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Stewardship	Faithful management of what God owns and entrusts, including time, money, gifts, work, and opportunities.
Faith	Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Service	Using God's gifts for His glory and the good of others, especially in the life of the church.
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see faithful stewardship from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. This truth begins the stewardship and service section by considering God's ownership and the believer's responsibility to be faithful.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

1 Corinthians 4:2 and Psalm 24:1 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. Now, we're going to look at in a moment an extended passage in Matthew chapter 25 verses 14 to 29.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it

commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. Many believers today understand the importance of reading their Bible, praying, and attending church. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

1 Corinthians 4:2

1 Corinthians 4:2 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read 1 Corinthians 4:2 first, then read Psalm 24:1. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

Sadly, it is common for Christians to slip into spiritual complacency.

Study the passage:

1. *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
2. *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
3. *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*

FRAMEWORK

Stewardship Under God's Ownership

FAITHFUL STEWARDSHIP	SELF-OWNERSHIP
Everything belongs to God.	My time, money, and gifts exist mainly for me.

FAITHFUL STEWARDSHIP	SELF-OWNERSHIP
Service flows from gratitude and calling.	Service is optional unless convenient.
Faithfulness is measured before the Lord.	Worth is measured by visibility or applause.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does faithful stewardship most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. so, when we have a proper understanding that God owns everything, then we begin to see ourselves not as the owners, but rather as managers. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. Many believers today understand the importance of reading their Bible, praying, and attending church. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Faithful stewardship belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. Many believers today understand the importance of reading their Bible, praying, and attending church. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **faithful stewardship should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **God has not only saved us from sin, but he has also saved us for a purpose.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

- 1. What should become clearer in your thinking about faithful stewardship?*
- 2. Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*
- 3. What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about faithful stewardship. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use 1 Corinthians 4:2 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
